

Declan Worley

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Highly driven Network Engineer with hands-on experience managing and optimizing enterprise-scale DoD/DoW networks within the Marine Corps Enterprise Network (MCEN). Skilled in troubleshooting advanced routing, VPN technologies, and 802.1x authentication across classified and unclassified environments. CCNP Security certified with a specialization in Secure VPN, leveraging deep expertise in network segmentation, AAA, 802.1x, and IPsec architectures to strengthen mission-critical communications and network security. Experienced in network automation using Ansible and NETCONF to streamline deployments, reduce downtime, and ensure configuration consistency across complex environments. Committed to continuous learning and technical excellence, actively mentoring team members to enhance collective capability and operational readiness. Driven by a goal to advance network reliability, scalability, and security through collaboration, innovation, and lifelong learning.

CERTIFICATIONS

- **CCNP Security (DoD 8570.01-M IAT Level III)** July 12, 2025
 - **SCOR 350-701 & SVPN 300-730**
- **Cisco Certified Networking Associate (CCNA)** July 2024
- **CompTIA Security+ (DoD 8570.01-M IAT Level II)** October 2023

EDUCATION AND PERSONAL GROWTH

High Point University

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science (Cybersecurity Concentration), Physics Minor

High Point, NC

August 2018 – May 2022

Self-Education & Professional Development

- Actively engaging in self-directed learning and real-world lab environments to gain extensive hands-on experience in network security, administration, and cloud technologies.
- Regularly research emerging cybersecurity threats, vulnerabilities, and best practices to stay up to date with network defense and IT infrastructure security.
- Completed multiple advanced courses and certifications covering cloud security, network management, and firewall configurations, further solidifying expertise with defense-in-depth strategies and network boundary security.

RELATED EXPERIENCE

Avening Management and Technical Services (Leidos NGEN-R SMIT)

NetOps Specialist MID/Senior

MCBH Kaneohe Bay, HI

July 2025 – April 2026

Responsible for optimizing network performance and ensuring seamless integration of classified and unclassified network services within the Marine Corps Enterprise Network (MCEN). Lead troubleshooting efforts, contributed to network design improvements, and implemented configurations in compliance with DoD security standards/STIGs. Supported over 300 network devices and maintained network security, availability, and performance.

- Resolved routing issues and IKEv1/ISAKMP tunnel issues on the classified network using KG-TACLANE devices, solving base-wide lateral connectivity that persisted for years; Implemented GRE tunnels to temporarily resolve routing issues in classified network areas. Enhanced network monitoring & security by correcting SNMP strings.
- Spearheaded the 802.1x troubleshooting efforts to reduce unit's overall workload across other sections with network outage incident tickets, reducing end user down-time and ticket resolution time.
- Planned, lead and successfully executed the rollout of DHCP on MCEN-S, aligning MCBH with MCEN standards and improving the efficiency of deploying new assets on the network.
- Utilized Remedy ticketing system to manage and resolve 5+ network-related incidents daily, addressing issues such as asset connectivity, VLAN misconfigurations, and AAA issues with ForeScout and Cisco ISE, reducing ticket resolution time.
- Worked in a Cisco SDA environment, utilizing Catalyst Center to monitor, configure, and deploy fabric sites on the MCEN network, ensuring proper service levels and compliance with MCEN standards. Leveraged Ansible/NETCONF to push updates during periods of downtime, minimizing service disruptions and improving operational efficiency.
- Collaborated with other sections to install and provision new fabric sites, including physically installing border nodes and edge nodes, successfully connecting previously isolated fabric sites.
- Supported network-side tech refresh initiatives and hardware replacement operations across both NIPR and SIPR networks, including coordinating appliance upgrades, validating configuration integrity before and after cutover, and rapidly diagnosing and replacing failed components to restore connectivity with minimal downtime.
- Identified and resolved network-wide issues caused by incorrect VLAN configurations that were impacting RADIUS attribute propagation.
- Communicated with 3D Net Battalion Watch Officer to resolve new network infrastructure outages and other network incidents as they were reported, reducing incident resolution time.

Responsible for management, integration, and the optimization of network services and end-user IT support in both NIPR & SIPR environments, ensuring adherence to DoD security and operational standards.

- Utilizing Remedy ticket system to track, process, and manage hardware and software requests, ensure proper configuration, secure imaging, and integrate assets into the Marine Corps Enterprise Network (MCEN), in compliance with DoD security protocols.
- Developed PowerShell scripts to automate IT tasks, improving efficiency, reducing manual workload, as well as ensuring compliance with DoD security protocols.
- Configuring & hardening devices to ensure 802.1x network authentication compliance, integrate them into the domain, and ensure network security before deployment across NIPR and SIPR networks.
- Configured and troubleshot Trellox Endpoint Security across NIPR and SIPR environments, ensuring endpoint policy compliance, managing agent deployments, and identifying security gaps in alignment with DoD security standards.
- Performing troubleshooting for end users and resolve issues related to user/admin accounts, Active Directory, Office 365 email, and network connectivity, leveraging tools like Microsoft SCCM and PowerShell for automation and system management.
- Managing & maintaining user/admin accounts within Active Directory, ensuring compliance with DoD naming conventions, extension attributes, and security protocols across network environments.
- Collaborating with network and security teams in 3d Network Battalion to ensure proper configuration, firewall integrity, and load balancing solutions across the network infrastructure to meet performance and availability targets.
- Provided troubleshooting support and escalating issues when necessary, ensuring compliance with Service-Level Target (SLT) timelines for all VIP tickets.
- Updated and maintained Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs), ensuring alignment with USMC, DoD, and industry best practices for end-user services and network management.
- Configuring network assets in MCEN, ensuring devices are securely integrated and compliant with emerging network technologies and network security principles.
- Working with teams to ensure Continuous Service Improvements (CSI) are implemented and that all IT systems are optimized for performance, security, and operational efficiency.
- Managing & maintaining network security, including ensuring firewall configuration and monitoring network traffic to identify potential issues, providing solutions to optimize and secure the network boundary.

HPU PantherSec
Team Member

High Point, NC
August 2019 – May 2022

- Led the team in various Capture the Flag (CTF) competitions, gaining global recognition by placing 57th in DarkCTF 2021. Applied advanced techniques in network forensics, exploit development, and penetration testing to uncover vulnerabilities in complex, multi-tiered networks.
- Facilitated knowledge sharing by developing and delivering hands-on training for team members on advanced cybersecurity tools like Wireshark, Burp Suite, OSINT, and Metasploit, helping to hone the team's skills in ethical hacking, vulnerability assessment, and network exploitation.
- Authored detailed technical reports and exploitation writeups, documenting methodologies, reverse engineering techniques, and post-exploitation analysis to enhance the team's incident response capabilities.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to deploy custom network attack simulations to test defenses, refine incident detection protocols, and identify gaps in security architecture and response strategies

Triad Math and Science Academy
IT Assistant

Greensboro, NC
June 2015 – May 2018

- Provided hands-on technical support for students and staff and troubleshooting a wide range of hardware & software issues across the school's network, ensuring minimal downtime for academic activities.
- Played a key role in network administration, including the installation and configuration of networked devices, ensuring secure and optimized access to school resources.
- Led efforts to proactively secure the school's network infrastructure by regularly updating operating systems, applications, and firewall configurations to mitigate vulnerabilities and prevent cyber threats.
- Diagnosed and resolved complex connectivity issues across the campus, improving network reliability and performance, and enhancing the overall user experience for staff and students.
- Supported classroom technology, including smartboards, ensuring all equipment was fully functional, secure, and properly integrated into the school's networks.

SKILLS

Programming Languages: Python, C, C++, JavaScript, SQL

Platforms & Tools: Cisco Catalyst Center, Ansible, Trellix, AWS, Azure, VMWare, Nessus, SolarWinds, Docker

Network Design & Integration: Cisco SDA, Load Balancing, Firewall Configuration, LAN/WAN Management, Hardware Refresh

Networking: Cisco IOS, Network Administration, LAN, NAT, WAN, OSPF, EIGRP, STP, BGP, QoS, PIM, AnyConnect

Security: AAA, 802.1x, Cisco TrustSec, Firewalls, ForeScout, STIG, Wireless Security, VPN, Network Segmentation, IPsec, ISAKMP

TECHNICAL PROJECTS – (<https://github.com/declanmworley>)

Nessus Vulnerability Scanner Lab

- Configured and used Nessus to conduct vulnerability assessments on a live network, identifying critical security flaws and generating comprehensive remediation reports to improve overall security posture.
- Integrated Nessus scans into a security operations workflow, automating vulnerability detection and prioritization to enhance incident response efficiency.

Cloud-Based Password Manager

- Designed and deployed a secure, cloud-based password management solution using Passbolt and Nginx on AWS, leveraging modern encryption standards and access control policies to protect sensitive credentials.
- Implemented multi-factor authentication (MFA) and stringent access control rules to ensure only authorized users can retrieve and manage sensitive information.

Honeypot using Microsoft Azure

- Deployed a T-Pot honeypot on Microsoft Azure, leveraging multiple sensors to monitor and analyze cyber-attacks in real-time, helping improve the organization's cyber defense strategy.
- Used data collected from the honeypot to analyze malware activity, track attack vectors, and refine security measures for future incident detection.

AI-Enhanced SIEM Incident Management using Microsoft Sentinel

- Integrated ChatGPT into Microsoft Sentinel on Azure to automate the incident enrichment, leveraging AI to enhance the accuracy and speed of threat identification and remediation processes.
- Deployed custom analytics rules within Microsoft Sentinel to identify potential threats proactively, leading to a faster remediation time and enhanced cyber threat intelligence.
- Simulated multiple advanced attack scenarios to evaluate the security monitoring tools and optimize the incident response process.